

4 Cdn Div / JTFC Article Submission

Reference: [Maple Leaf Article – Submission Guidelines](#)

Title	<i>Title should have an active verb and 60 characters max. A title with an active verb can convey the gist of the article.</i>
A Career in the Army Reserve: My Progression from Co-op Student to Instructor	
Byline	<i>By Author Names, Unit</i>
By Master Corporal Andres Mona Jaramillo, Section Commander & Unit Public Affairs Representative with 4 th Battalion The Royal Canadian Regiment, London, ON	
Article	<i>The overall lead should not exceed approximately 450 words in English and 500 words in French. The language should be simple, and avoid jargon, passive voice, and long and juxtaposed sentences to the extent possible.</i>
Word count: 464 I joined the Army reserve when I was 18 years old, when in my final year of high school two recruiters would appear to offer the co-op program. I gave it a chance and have enjoyed amazing experiences in the past five years. What these recruiters spoke to my school about was an opportunity where we, as students, could train and become soldiers and receive high school credits. As a kid, I always wanted to be a soldier and many members of my family have served both in the Colombian and US militaries. During that time, I had opportunities that as an adolescent I would have never imagined I would accomplish. I completed my Basic training and the Infantry trade course, all within my 12th-grade year, and that summer I graduated as a fully qualified soldier. Throughout the years, I have had impactful experiences, such as participating in speaking engagements at elementary schools and high schools for Remembrance Day. I have also had the opportunity to work with the Canadian Rangers (3CRPG) and the junior rangers, supporting Indigenous communities and advancing the cause of reconciliation. During the height of the Covid pandemic, I supported my community throughout those troubling times in the capacity of a soldier, all while completing my university undergrad. At length, these experiences prepared me for the challenges of service. Being away, being cold, tired, in pain, and sometimes even a little stressed, being part of a team was the most rewarding. In more recent years, I have had the privilege and great responsibility of becoming a leader within the institution. Though many times an enormous challenge, I have had the advantage of being surrounded by experienced, professional, and dedicated mentors that have demonstrated the qualities of a good soldier and leader. Thanks to these opportunities, I have been a Section commander within my unit for nearly two years, I have had the amazing experience of teaching on an Infantry PLQ and ISCC, and even more recently, I was nominated as my Unit's Public Affairs Representative.	

All these experiences have been vital to my professional development. They have allowed me to improve and develop a plethora of skills in verbal and written communication, stress management, time management and so on. These skills have been tremendously advantageous and have helped me both while undertaking my bachelor's degree and now during the Master's I am currently studying.

In closing, the Army Reserve for me has become a profession, a passion, and most importantly, a family. I am privileged and excited to inform the new generation of the great opportunity they now have. That teenager, that was mentioned earlier, has now become a leader, and part of something bigger than he could have ever imagined and this same opportunity exists for so many others.

Captions

Captions must include the photo's file name, description of the photo and photo credit.

File Name 20221126LXC220154D023.jpg

Caption The 4th Canadian Division command team, Brigadier-General Josh Major and Chief Warrant Officer Jeramie Leamon discuss their response to a request for assistance from Ontario with Deputy Minister of Emergency Management, Bernie Derible.

Photo credit

Alt text

Metadata

Keywords

Exercise, Support, Toronto, Ontario, Disaster, Denison, Planning, Scenario, Training, Domestic, Liaising, Emergency